

Checklist

Engineering Executive: Organizational Values

1. Clarify the Purpose of Values

- ☐ Have we clearly articulated what decisions our values are meant to guide?
- ☐ Are our values intended to reinforce existing cultural changes (not magically create new ones)?
- ☐ Do senior leaders actively model these values?

2. Decide the Scope of Values

- ☐ Should we extend existing company values rather than create new ones?
- ☐ If needed, are we choosing intentionally between:
 - ☐ Company-wide values
 - ☐ Engineering values
 - ☐ Engineering leadership values
- ☐ Are the proposed values truly relevant to Engineering's work?

3. Evaluate Each Value for Quality

Reversible

- ☐ Can this value be reasonably reversed without sounding nonsensical?
- ☐ Does it represent a real strategic choice (not just a universally good statement)?
- ☐ Would another successful company reasonably choose the opposite?

Applicable

- ☐ Can this value guide real, complex decisions?
- ☐ Does it help in trade-offs (e.g., speed vs. quality, build vs. buy)?
- ☐ Can it be used in planning, hiring, performance reviews, and promotions?
- ☐ Would team members know how to apply it in a specific scenario?

Honest

- ☐ Does this value accurately describe how the organization behaves today?
- ☐ Are top performers already modeling this behavior?
- ☐ Is it grounded in reality rather than aspiration?
- ☐ If behavior needs to change, are we changing behavior first before documenting it?

4. Avoid Common Traps

Identity Values

- ☐ Is this more about how we want to *see ourselves* than about how we make decisions?
- ☐ Would someone rarely use this value when deciding what to do next?

Vague Prioritization Values

- ☐ Does this value actually help prioritize work?
- ☐ Does it provide context for trade-offs?
- ☐ Is it more than a slogan?

5. Plan the Rollout Carefully

- ☐ Have we waited long enough to understand the organization before introducing new values?
- ☐ Have we tested the values in small groups first?
- ☐ Did we involve key stakeholders early?
- ☐ Did we iterate before finalizing?

- ☐ Are we building buy-in rather than announcing top-down?

6. Integrate Values Into Daily Work

- ☐ Are values integrated into hiring (including allowing candidates to opt out)?
- ☐ Are values explicitly discussed during onboarding?
- ☐ Are promotions tied to value-aligned behavior?
- ☐ Do 1:1s and team meetings reinforce value-aligned accomplishments?
- ☐ Are values referenced in major decision discussions?

7. Align With Strategy

- ☐ Do the values reinforce and clarify the organization's strategy?
- ☐ Can each value act as a guiding principle for strategic decisions?
- ☐ Is the overlap between strategy and values intentional and coherent?

8. Maintain and Evolve

- ☐ Are we revisiting values periodically?
- ☐ Are we adjusting values as behavior and strategy evolve?
- ☐ Are leaders consistently held accountable for modeling them?